- Business Communication and Creating Impressions
  - Effective Presentation Skills
    - Planning & Developing
      - Select topic of interest
      - Determine purpose of message
      - Identify major points & support
      - Develop strong opening and closing
      - Arrange for proper introduction
      - Creating Bullet Points in PPT
    - Organizing Presentation Parts
      - Introduction (Tell them what you will tell them)
        - Captures audience attention
        - Establishes rapport
        - Presents purpose and previews points
        - Attention-Getting Techniques
          - Shocking statement/statistic
          - Quotation by expert
          - Rhetorical/open-ended question
          - Appropriate joke/humor
          - Demonstration/aid
          - Related story/anecdote
          - Personal reference/compliment
      - Body (Tell them)
        - Provide support in easy-to-understand form
        - Provide relevant statistics
        - Use quotes from prominent people
        - Use jokes and humor appropriately
        - Use interesting anecdotes
        - Use presentation visuals
      - Conclusion (Tell them what you told them)
        - Make creative and memorable
        - Tie closing to introduction for unity
        - Use transition words
        - Practice close to deliver smoothly
        - Smile and accept applause
    - Knowing Your Audience & Purpose
      - Identify audience and requestor
      - Why is topic important to audience?
      - How will environment affect presentation?
      - Identify Purpose (Audience will...)
    - Presentation Delivery
      - Achieving Good Vocal Quality
        - Breathe properly and relax
        - Listen to yourself
        - Develop flexibility
        - Pay attention to articulation
        - Vary Voice Elements
          - Volume and pace (loudness for clarity, emphasis)
          - Pitch (rises for questions, lowers for severity)
      - Types of Delivery Methods
        - Memorized (delivered verbatim)
        - Manuscript/Scripted (written and read)
        - Impromptu (no prior notice)
        - Extemporaneous (planned, rehearsed, not written in detail)
    - Effective Visual Aids
      - Advantages of Visuals
        - Clarifies and emphasizes points
        - Increases retention (14% to 38%)
        - Reduces time to present concepts
        - Increases speaker goal achievement (34% more often)
        - Increases group consensus (21% in meetings)
      - Types of Visuals
        - Multimedia (high-tech equipment)
        - Still projection options
        - Board and flipchart (informal discussion)
        - Hard copy (detailed augmentation)
      - Space Design & Typography
        - Limit amount of text on slide
        - Use graphic devices for attention
        - Use appropriate page orientation
        - Use left alignment of text
        - Capitalize first letter of bullets
        - Eliminate periods, avoid abbreviations
    - Alternate Delivery Situations
      - Culturally Diverse Audiences
        - Use simple English/short sentences
        - Avoid emotion-triggering words
        - Enunciate carefully, speak slowly
        - Use humor/jokes cautiously
        - Seek feedback for understanding
        - Consider cultural preferences (style, nonverbal, formality)
      - Delivering as a Team
        - Select a winning team
        - Agree on purpose and schedule
        - Plan seamless transitions/natural bridge
        - Deliver and field questions as a team
      - Distance Delivery (Virtual/Web)
        - Ensure presentation is appropriate
        - Establish rapport prior to presentation
        - Gain proficiency in technology
        - Develop high-quality graphics
        - Plan attire carefully (avoid patterns/bright colors)
        - Speak in crisp, conversational tone
        - Pay attention to body language
        - Avoid culturally insensitive gestures
        - Practice with a colleague
    - Do's & Don'ts of a Good Presentation
  - Interviews and Employment Preparation
    - Preparation Checklist (Do's)
      - Prepare no later than the night before
      - Make a checklist of what to take
      - Ensure directions and timing are set
      - Choose outfit in advance (clean/ironed)
      - Research company (history, mission, developments)
      - Outline answers to common questions
      - Know the interview format
    - Preparation Checklist (Don'ts)
      - Don't wait until morning to gather materials
      - Don't be late (arrive 10 minutes early)
      - Don't try to memorize answers (remember key points)
    - Important Documents
      - Resume (well crafted, up to date, appealing)
      - Project information documents
      - Recommendation letter (optional)
    - Types of Employment Interviews
      - Structured interviews
      - Unstructured interviews
      - Virtual Interviews
    - Interview Process Steps
      - The Phone Screener
      - The Skill Test
      - The In-Person Interview
      - The Group Panel
      - The Candidate Presentation
    - Interview Techniques
      - STAR Response Technique
        - Situation (Describe challenge faced)
        - Task (Explain role in situation)
        - Action (Offer steps taken)
        - Result (Describe results of actions)
      - Handling Expected Questions
        - Why Should We Employ You?
          - Point out strong academic performance
          - Insight on industrial visit/work culture adaptation
          - Highlight good qualities (leadership, team spirit, commitment, technical knowledge)
        - Tell Us About Your Project Work
          - Give technical details
          - Describe team work level
          - Describe project applicability
        - Offers from Other Companies (Be honest, don't provide details unless asked)
        - Expected Salary (Be prepared well in advance)
        - Opinion About the Company (Talk about products/influence)
      - General Questions
        - What makes you unique?
        - Are you able to multi-task?
        - How would colleagues describe you?
        - How do you organize your typical day?
        - Strengths and weakness?
        - How do you handle failure?
        - How do you feel about constructive criticism?
      - Engineering Specific Questions
        - Most difficult project and how you solved it
        - Explain engineering ideas to unfamiliar audience
        - What do you enjoy most/least about engineering?
        - New engineering skills developed?
    - Technical Skills Examples
      - Programming languages
      - Common operating systems
      - Software proficiency
      - Technical writing
      - Project management
      - Data analysis